

Ian Cowpar

Technical-domain PM | AI as core multiplier | turns ambiguous systems problems into product direction | async-native, zero-translation

ian.cowpar@gmail.com | 351-235-0365 | linkedin.com/in/ian-cowpar | theunofficialleader.substack.com

SUMMARY

Senior Product Manager who turns ambiguous, technical problems into clear product direction — partnering shoulder-to-shoulder with deeply technical engineering teams, not adjacent to them. I ship the working prototype, not just the spec: I wrote a 0→1 platform-migration tool's prototype myself in Claude Code, and it's in production today. Two years at UKG inside a \$250M ARR enterprise platform program; a decade prior at Broadridge in compliance-grade financial services, where regional, regulatory, and operational constraints were the product, not a footnote. Async-native — my entire career has run across distributed teams and time zones — and AI-forward by default: I built an organization's first organized AI capability layer and write weekly on AI as a productivity multiplier.

EXPERIENCE

Senior Product Manager Jun 2024 – Apr 2026

UKG | Remote / Lowell, MA | \$250M ARR platform program | Platform migration tooling, AI capability, and technical product direction

- **Took an ambiguous platform-migration problem from concept to a deployment model engineering could build on.** Customers and their configuration had to move between deployment environments — previously a ticket-gated, engineering-run extraction and old-to-new structure mapping. I decomposed the problem (UI, rules, deployment), wrote the working prototype myself in Claude Code, defined requirements with the platform architect, and delivered a complete package — epics, stories, sequencing, roadmap. In production: tenant moves run self-serve, engineering out of the critical path.
- **Built the organization's first organized AI capability layer.** Started as a personal automation library; built it into shared infrastructure 20 PMs could pull from, ran the first peer group, configured it with individual PMs for their own workflows. Spread without a mandate — the shared-ownership-pool model, before it had that name: build where it has the most impact, make it reusable, let it propagate.
- **Turned a chaotic technical signal problem into product clarity** — a five-panel system classifying open issues across escalations, defects, internal bugs, CVEs, and noise across four products, with a Claude Code function surfacing the single highest-leverage action per panel. Cut a ~200-item working list to a real five so engineering acted on signal, not noise.
- **Built a composite risk model** scoring the top accounts on exposure, case volume, true-defect signal, and sentiment — not raw counts — with automated reporting that surfaced aging technical risk before it escalated.
- **Designed delivery-health instrumentation** refreshing every 15 minutes across two engineering teams, with documented rejection criteria for burndown, velocity, and delivery anti-patterns — each with technical rationale.
- **Was the product-side voice in the engineering escalation room** — synthesizing what 300 enterprise customers (\$250M ARR) needed (including regional, compliance, and operational requirements) against what was committed, and feeding that into prioritization and tradeoff decisions.

Business Analyst Jan 2014 – Jun 2024

Broadridge Financial Solutions | Andover, MA

- Led 40+ enterprise client deployments end-to-end in a compliance-grade, regulated environment; partnered deeply with engineering on system behavior, data flows, integration dependencies, and isolation/regional handling, building credibility in system-design and deployment discussions.

- Internal SME for an omni-channel platform adopted across the full client base; translated complex technical and compliance constraints into clear product direction non-technical stakeholders could act on.

Sr. Document Development Analyst Jan 2006 – Jan 2014

Broadridge Financial Solutions | Andover, MA

SKILLS AND FOCUS AREAS

Product: Turning ambiguous technical problems into product strategy and actionable plans, 0→1 product building, requirements definition with engineering, prioritization and tradeoff facilitation, shared-ownership delivery models, async distributed collaboration, B2B SaaS

AI as Core Multiplier: Claude Code prototyping, AI embedded in daily workflow by default, AI capability enablement at org scale, agentic workflows, AI-fluent product development, zero-translation building

Technical & Systems Fluency: Partnering with deeply technical engineering teams, system-behavior and integration tradeoffs, data flows and migration between environments, deployment-model and platform product thinking, APIs, requirements engineering

Compliance & Operational: Compliance-grade regulated delivery, regional / isolation / operational-readiness requirements, regulatory-consequence rigor, executive and cross-functional stakeholder synthesis

Communication: Clear written and verbal explanation of complex technical topics to varied audiences, executive-level synthesis, weekly published technical writing, distributed-team documentation discipline

Tooling: Jira, Confluence, GitHub, SQL, Slack MCP, Claude Code CLI

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Science, Management Information Systems and Management

Manning School of Business, UMass Lowell | 1999

WRITING AND THOUGHT LEADERSHIP

The Unofficial Leader (Substack) | theunofficialleader.substack.com

Weekly publication on AI adoption as a productivity multiplier, distributed/async work, and what's happening beneath the surface of how technical teams operate. Originator of the Zero-Translation Building framework.